30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

GIT QUEST

LEVEL 10

DOUBLE DIGITS!

git commit --amend: Fix Your Last Commit

Week 2: Undo and Branch | Absolute Beginner

QUEST PROGRESS: DAY 10 OF 30

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The Story: Reopen the Box

Commit the Cat sealed the box too fast. Luckily, it can be reopened.

1

The mistake

A typo in the message, or a file you forgot to pack. It happens to everyone.

2

--amend -m

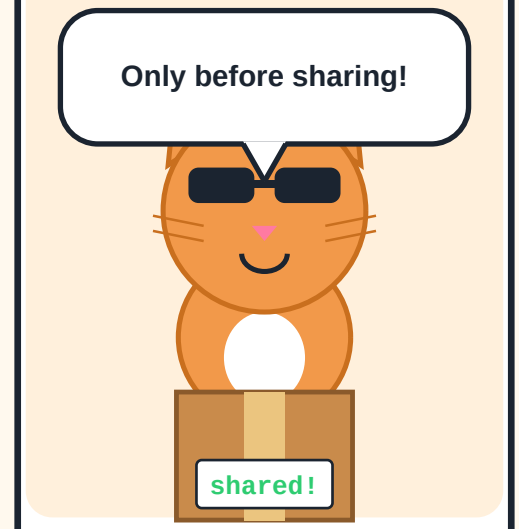
Replaces the message on your last commit with a corrected one.

3

--no-edit

Stage the forgotten file, then amend. The old message stays.

4

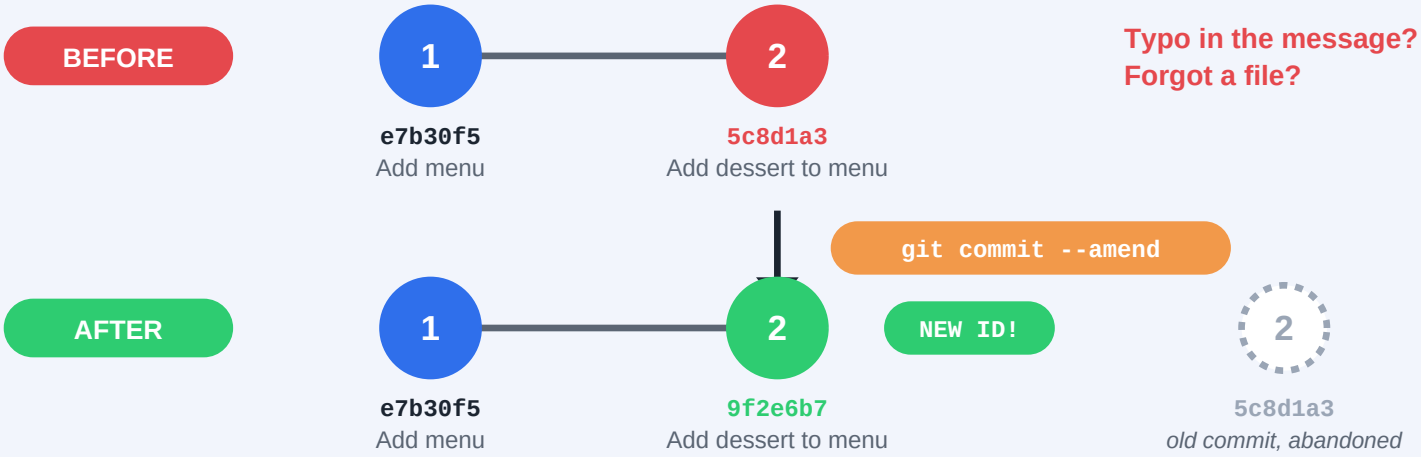


Golden rule

Amending makes a new commit. Never rewrite commits other people already have.

What Amend Really Does

Git doesn't edit the old commit. It swaps it for a brand-new one.



THREE WAYS TO USE IT

FIX THE MESSAGE

```
git commit --amend
  -m "Add menu"
```

Replaces the label on your last commit.

ADD A FORGOTTEN FILE

```
git add dessert.txt
git commit --amend --no-edit
```

--no-edit keeps the old message.

FIX A SMALL MISTAKE

```
(edit the file)
git add menu.txt
git commit --amend --no-edit
```

Same trick for a typo inside a file.

Golden rule: only amend commits you have NOT shared!

Quest Board: Fix Your Commit

Finish 4 quests, then collect today's commit.

1 Make a commit with a typo

```
$ git init -b main amend-lab && cd amend-lab
$ echo "Pasta" > menu.txt
$ git add menu.txt && git commit -m "Add mnu"
```

2 Fix the message

```
$ git commit --amend -m "Add menu"
$ git log --oneline
```

Look: the hash changed! A new commit replaced the old one.

3 Commit, then forget a file

```
$ echo "Dessert" >> menu.txt
$ git add menu.txt && git commit -m "Add dessert to menu"
$ echo "Dessert recipe" > dessert.txt
```

4 Sneak the file in

```
$ git add dessert.txt
$ git commit --amend --no-edit
$ git show --stat
```

Both files, one commit. The message stayed the same.

LOOT: TODAY'S COMMIT

COMMIT

`days-1-to-10-summary.md`

```
docs(day10): add days 1-10 summary and amend notes
```

Recap of Days 1 to 10 plus amend notes.

GOLDEN RULE

Only amend commits that are still on your computer. Shared commits should never be rewritten: make a new commit instead.

STUCK IN AN EDITOR?

```
Esc   then   :wq   then   Enter
```

Amend without -m or --no-edit opens an editor (often Vim). Save and quit with :wq.

Boss Fight and Bonus Loot

Cheat sheet, comparisons, quiz and your next unlock.

BONUS 1: DAY 10 CHEAT SHEET

```
git commit --amend -m "msg"   Fix the message
git add <file>                Stage a forgotten file
git commit --amend --no-edit  Add it, keep the message
git log --oneline             Notice the new hash
git show --stat               Which files are in it?
```

BONUS 2: AMEND vs RESET --SOFT

```
amend                      one command, fixes the last commit
reset --soft HEAD~1 + commit   same result, two steps
```

BONUS 3: ESCAPE THE EDITOR (VIM)

```
Esc, :wq, Enter     save and quit
Esc, :q!, Enter     quit without saving
```

BOSS FIGHT: QUICK QUIZ

1. Which flag keeps the old message when you amend?
2. Does amend edit the old commit or create a new one?
3. When should you never amend a commit?

Answers: 1) --no-edit 2) A new commit with a new hash 3) After the commit has been shared

CHALLENGE

Make a commit with a typo, fix it with amend, then forget a file and add it with --no-edit. Compare the hashes in git log.

LEVEL 11: What is a branch?

Unlocks tomorrow. Meet one of the biggest ideas in Git.

LOCKED